

# CHANGHAO LI

Mobile: (404) 384-7151 | Email: cli911@gatech.edu | Home Page : [lichangh20.github.io](https://lichangh20.github.io) | Github: [lichangh20](https://github.com/lichangh20)

## EDUCATIONS

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**Georgia Institute of Technology, Ph.D.**

08/2024 – Present

- Advised by Professor Bo Dai and Professor Chao Zhang
- **Research Interests:** LLM Agent; RLHF; Agentic RL
- **Programming Languages:** Python, C++, PyTorch (Framework)

**Tsinghua University, Undergraduate**

09/2020 – 06/2024

B.Eng. in Computer Science and Technology (GPA: 3.89 / 4.00)

- Member of **TSAIL** (Tsinghua Statistical Artificial Intelligence & Learning), advised by Professor Jianfei Chen and Professor Jun Zhu
- **Research Direction:** High Efficient Machine Learning; Parameter-efficient Tuning of LLM

## SELECTED PUBLICATIONS (\* denotes equal contribution)

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**Changhao Li**, Rushi Qiang, Jiawei Huang, Chenxiao Gao, Hanjun Dai, Chao Zhang, Niao He, Bo Dai.  
[“Revisiting Dagger in the Era of LLM-Agents”](#). Preprint 2026

We revisit DAGger for long-horizon LM agents, introducing teacher-interleaved trajectory collection that combines on-policy state coverage with dense expert supervision to mitigate covariate shift and improve software-engineering agents.

Elad Ben Avraham\*, **Changhao Li\***, Ron Dorfman\*, Roy Ganz, Oren Nuriel, Amir Dudai, Aviad Aberdam, Noah Flynn, Elman Mansimov, Aditya Kalyanpur, Ron Litman. [“DREAM: Deep Research Evaluation with Agentic Metrics.”](#) ACL 2026 (Oral)

We introduce **DREAM**, an agentic evaluation framework that enables temporally grounded, tool-based, and reference-free assessment of deep research report.

**Changhao Li**, Yuchen Zhuang, Chenxiao Gao, Haotian Sun, Rushi Qiang, Chao Zhang, Bo Dai.  
[“Exploration-Driven Optimization for Test-Time Large Language Model Reasoning.”](#) TMLR 2026

We introduce **Exploration-Driven Optimization (EDO)**, a post-training framework that encourages exploration in RL-based LLM optimization to improve diversity and long-horizon reasoning, yielding consistent gains with test-time scaling methods.

**Changhao Li\***, Yuchen Zhuang\*, Rushi Qiang, Haotian Sun, Hanjun Dai, Chao Zhang, Bo Dai.  
[“Matryoshka Pilot: Learning to Drive Black-Box LLMs with LLMs”](#). NeurIPS 2025 [\[code\]](#)

We introduce **Matryoshka Pilot (M-Pilot)**, a lightweight white-box controller that guides black-box LLMs via intermediate task decomposition. Through iterative interaction, M-Pilot enables controllable multi-turn generation and improves performance on long-horizon reasoning, planning, and personalization tasks.

**Changhao Li\***, Xinrui Chen\*, Ji Wang\*, Kang Zhao, Jianfei Chen. [“Task-Specific Zero-shot Quantization-Aware Training for Object Detection”](#). ICCV 2025 [\[code\]](#)

We propose a zero-shot quantization framework for object detection. Extensive experiments on MS-COCO and Pascal VOC across both CNN- and transformer-based detectors demonstrate that our method enables effective low-precision training without access to real data.

Haocheng Xi, **Changhao Li**, Jianfei Chen, Jun Zhu. [“Training Transformers with 4-bit Integers”](#). *NeurIPS 2023* [\[code\]](#)

We propose a 4-bit training method for transformers that achieves competitive accuracy across diverse tasks while running 2.2× faster than FP16 on current GPUs. I primarily implemented the CUDA kernels and contributed to the algorithm design.

Rushi Qiang\*, Yuchen Zhuang\*, Yinghao Li, Dingu Sagar V K, Rongzhi Zhang, Changhao Li, Ian Shu-Hei Wong, Sherry Yang, Percy Liang, Chao Zhang, Bo Dai. [“MLE-Dojo: Interactive Environments for Empowering LLM Agents in Machine Learning Engineering”](#). *NeurIPS 2025* [\[code\]](#)

**INDUSTRIAL EXPERIENCES**

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- > **Apply Scientist Intern, AWS AI Lab. Manager: Elman Mansimov**

Research Direction: Deep Research Evaluation

2025

**ACADEMIC SERVICES**

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- > Reviewer for conferences: ICML (2025), NeurIPS (2025), ARR (2024-2025)
- > Reviewer for journals: TMLR
- > Teaching Assistant: [CX4240 - Computing for Data Analysis](#) (2026 Spring)

**SELECTED AWARDS & HONORS**

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- > Outstanding Graduates Awards in Dept. of CST, Tsinghua University

2024
- > Comprehensive Excellence Scholarship, highest scholarship in Dept. of CST

2023
- > Academic & Social Worker Excellence Scholarship, Tsinghua University

2022
- > First Prize in National High School Mathematics League, China Mathematical Association

2020